



DREW DUDLEY

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

? WHAT DOES DREW TALK ABOUT?

Drew redefines leadership in a way that makes it more accessible to people in every organization/audience. He shifts the definition from power and titles to everyday behaviours, and then teaches individuals how to embed those behaviours into their daily routine.

? WHAT IS DREW'S BACKGROUND/WHAT ARE HIS CREDENTIALS?

Drew started out in the charitable sphere—he was National Chair of Canada's largest student charity before joining the University of Toronto to design and build their Leadership Development Program, which he grew that into one of the largest programs in the country. Eventually, the demand for him as a guest speaker and facilitator led to him leave the University and start his own company, Day One Leadership. He's worked with over 400 organizations since then, and recently published his first book, *This Is Day One: A Practical Guide to Leadership that Matters*, which became an international bestseller.

? HAS DREW SPOKEN TO AN AUDIENCE OF <XXXX>? / WHAT KIND OF AUDIENCES HAS HE WORKED WITH?

Drew has spoken to audiences from across all sectors and industries. Whether for senior managers, front-line service staff, blue-collar professionals, teachers, doctors, nurses, lawyers, or emergency service personnel, he has consistently received universal acclaim for his style and approach with most feedback being perfect. As a charismatic storyteller whose approach is relevant and intuitive to all, Drew is an attractive option for event organizers that want to achieve specific leadership development outcomes for audiences or simply inspire them to be a better version of themselves.

? WHAT SETS DREW APART AS A SPEAKER?

The two primary characteristics that set Drew apart as a speaker are his practicality and accessibility. Drew's presentations are designed to connect to the many people in every audience who don't see themselves as leaders.

He interweaves stories and humor with psychological phenomena and empirical data to help audiences redefine their perspective on leadership and then demonstrates how they can utilize their daily behaviours to achieve ongoing positive impact in their lives and careers. Most notably, Drew's presentation is one of the few presentations that is accessible to the introverts in the audience. Because his focus is on behaviours with which the audience is comfortable, he lets quieter individuals who might shy away from the concept of leadership know they too can be impactful leaders.



DOES DREW CUSTOMIZE HIS PRESENTATIONS?

Yes. In addition to attempting to accommodate the specific needs of prospective clients, Drew has customized his presentations in two specific ways to account for common requests he's received from past clients. First, he has adapted how he presents his material to appeal to those who typically comprise his presentations. This has resulted in three approaches to delivering his content:

1. A presentation for senior leadership teams, managers, or any audience where most of the people there have direct reports. It's a little more sophisticated, data-driven, and focuses on a practical approach to embedding leadership behaviours in employees that is rooted in behavioural psychology.
2. A presentation for audiences made up of people from all levels of an organization, or individuals without many direct reports. This one aims to help more people in the audience embrace the idea that they can be leaders and then teaches them how to do it. It's most notable feature is a tool called "The Leadership Test" that shows the audience how to commit to core leadership behaviours and then evaluate how well they did each day.
3. A presentation that focuses on the importance of self-respect and self-care in being an effective leader, team member, and person. This could be for any audience, as it focuses on five specific approaches to decision-making designed that ensure people stay emotionally, physically and intellectually strong and resilient.

Second, where certain organizers are looking to create alignment between their priorities and his work, he will often seek to implement their core values into the presentation—showing how the process he teaches can result in individuals defining those values as a commitment to performing a specific action through their roles/responsibilities and then creating a question to evaluate whether they've achieved the desired impact.



THE AUDIENCE IS FILLED WITH SOME PEOPLE WHO TEND TO BE A LITTLE CYNICAL ABOUT “LEADERSHIP EXPERTS” OR “MOTIVATIONAL SPEAKERS”. DOES DREW OFFER REALLY TANGIBLE, PRACTICAL TAKEAWAYS AND TOOLS?

Drew doesn't think of himself as a motivational speaker. Rather, he views himself as an educator that offers “useful, compelling ideas which are inherently motivating.” The Lollipop Moment story that went viral and has been viewed over 5 million times online, for example, is a motivational story that is intended to illustrate the idea that everyone can create moments of leadership. In this instance, he used storytelling as a mechanism to cultivate audience interest and then strengthen their commitment to the importance of making those moments more conscious and frequent every day. To ensure those stories have relevance, he ties everything he talks about to underlying research that shows each step he teaches is tied to employee engagement, retention, satisfaction and productivity. That tends to really connect with the more analytical, data-driven minds in the room.



WHAT EXACTLY IS THE PROCESS DREW IS TEACHING?

It's called the "Day One Leadership Approach," and it's premised on the idea that on Day One of any voyage to a goal, you need to define specific, non-negotiable behaviours that have to be a part of each and every day moving forward. The basis for the approach stems from his experience as a recovering alcoholic and someone who achieved significant weight loss: on Day One you identify what you have to do to stay sober or lose weight, and then you treat every day like it's your first day of that mission.

Through the Day One approach, Drew provides audiences with a very specific place to start when it comes to living their leadership, and a process to commit to those behaviours. He helps audiences to identify their own personal values and behaviours, and then teaches a process called "operationalizing leadership values" that they can use to make sure they stay committed to them each day. The latter process is based on behavioural psychology research that says unanswered questions are a powerful driver of human behaviour, so he shows how to turn behavioural goals into questions, and then use those questions to stay committed each day.



WHY DOES HAVING CLARITY ON ONE'S PERSONAL VALUES MATTER FROM A LEADERSHIP STANDPOINT?

Many theorists will argue that the concept of leadership is tied closely to impact which is derived from specific actions intended to transform the current state of a situation. Occasionally, these actions are derived intentionally through careful thought as to why and how they should unfold. Individuals who can consistently create these conditions in a way where a positive outcome results for themselves or others are leaders by Drew's definition.

However, Drew argues that much of the leadership on the planet is unconscious: performed by individuals who do not see it as leadership or themselves as leaders. He asserts that most individuals feel this way because they haven't yet developed a foundational personal leadership philosophy upon which to understand and apply themselves in a consistently impactful manner. Clarifying and then operationalizing one's personal leadership values and behaviours helps to fill this gap. Through use of the Day One Leadership approach, core leadership values are translated into commitments to daily positive leadership behaviours. By doing so, research has shown that these individuals are more likely to display higher levels of productivity, pride, commitment and happiness. Additionally, they score higher on trust and overall leadership effectiveness.



OUR THEME IS <CHOOSE FROM BELOW>, DOES DREW SPEAK ABOUT THAT?

Resilience/Grit

Resilience/Grit is a central theme in Drew's work. The Day One approach he teaches was heavily influenced by his experiences dealing with some huge challenges, and he uses many of them as examples of the process working in his life. He talks about how he's used it to stay sober, lose 100 pounds, effectively manage his bipolar disorder, and deal with the deaths of 20 of his friends.

One of the key benefits of his leadership process is that it's a road map through uncertainty. When you don't know what the future holds, this process keeps you focused on what you need to do today. That ensures that you keep momentum even if you're not sure exactly where it's taking you. He likes to say that "resilience is the ability to maintain momentum even when the universe is tossing mud under your tires," and his presentation aims to give practical advice on how to build and keep that momentum.

He includes a focus on resilience/grit in all his presentations, but he also has a specific presentation that does a deep dive into what he calls "the foundation of leadership"—self-respect. That presentation focuses specifically on five strategies for building self-respect and resilience/grit.

Disruption

Drew's work doesn't really lend itself specifically to this theme, as his focus is primarily on personal leadership and behavior (rather than tactics and insights for turning an organization or industry on its head with a new approach). However, if an organizer was looking to add a different perspective on what innovation and disruption means, they could leverage the Day One Leadership approach to help individuals be more deliberate and strategic in being innovative or disruptive. To this extent, the Day One Leadership approach can help these audiences define innovation and disruption as a commitment to certain non-negotiable actions and then create a question to evaluate whether they've been successful in performing those behaviours each day.

Productivity (can also be used for "Employee Engagement")

Drew's entire presentation is based on research that shows personal value clarity is tied directly to employee productivity, retention, pride and happiness. The Day One approach is designed to help employees identify, define and implement their personal leadership values. Drew says that one of the most significant opportunities for increased productivity in an organization is being completely ignored: helping your people understand what values they hope to embody in their work and giving them the opportunity to do so. His entire presentation is a step by step class on how to do just that.

Collaboration

Like with disruption, Drew's work doesn't really lend itself specifically to this theme, as his focus is primarily on personal leadership and behavior (rather than tactics and insights for building strong teams or avoiding/dealing with silos in an organization).

However, if an organizer was looking to add a different perspective on what collaboration means, they could leverage the Day One Leadership approach to help individuals be more deliberate and strategic in being collaborative. To this extent, the Day One Leadership approach can help these audiences define collaboration as a commitment to certain non-negotiable actions and then create a question to evaluate whether they've been successful in performing those behaviours each day.

Workplace Culture

One of Drew's most popular keynotes is called "This is Day One: Creating Cultures of Leadership." His approach to talking about culture however is very much focused on the personal: he says that all organizational cultures are the product of the individual cultures that make them up, so his focus is on helping people create their own personal culture of leadership. He lays out a step by step process for doing that on an individual level, and provides all kinds of data and insight on the increases in employee pride, retention, productivity and happiness that happens on an organizational level as a result.

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